

3. Three-day basketball focus

Last synced: 2026-07-30

Audience: Charles — deadline pressure

Goal: One clear “done” for the simplified model, without scope creep.

Status (2026-07-27): Re-entry bar reached on disk (agent/project). Your step-by-step checkoff: CHARLES_CHECKLIST.md .

What “done” means (72-hour bar)

Binding check: You can say in one breath: Hero = outcome; environment = L_net (B - D); advancement = score (S_i , λ) then select (top K); sim tests congestion in the score, not one giant environment model. (../BINDING_Selection_is_its_own_step.md)

You can stop spiraling when you can honestly say all four:

- 1. I can explain the hero in one minute (doc 01) — including talent baseline vs hero (two empirical axes).
- 2. I can explain three layers without merging them — score S_i = A_i + λ(B-D) , Alex v1 (B-D)=-L_C, knockout λ=0, then select top K (doc 02).
- 3. I have a side-by-side figure: empirical hero + generative sim, same advancement rate on Y, labeled axes.
- 4. I have one limitation sentence ready for Alex (below — copy when needed).

You do not need: bin-for-bin sim match, Rivanna sweeps, p calibrated to 530, tenure figures, manuscript Word inking, or refreshed Army plots in this window.

Minimal model for Alex’s intent (v1 — what he asked for)

Piece	What it is	Status
Empirical phenomenon	Naïve: P(draft own A_i) ≈ monotone; Hero: P(draft PoolQ_LOO) with tail dip	Done (530; doc 01)
Three-step generative	(1) assign (p); (2) score S_i ; (3) select top K	540_* + Model.pdf
Unified score	S_i = A_i + λ(B-D) ; Alex v1: (B-D)=-L_C ⇒ S_i = A_i - λ·L_C	Locked (doc 02)
Headline sim test	Knockout λ=0 (S_i = A_i) vs congestion in score — same league, same top-K	Pass A — see 04_Pass_A_and_Pass_B_in_Plain_English.md ; script hero_model_reset_bundle.py
Side-by-side + limits	Empirical + generative PNG; no bin-for-bin claim	Export folder (after you re-run Pass A)
p ablation	Vary assignment assortativity, fix score + winner rule — “is sorting involved?”	Pass B — doc 04; script 540_rho_ablation_bundle.py

Before any Pass A/B shorthand: read 04_Pass_A_and_Pass_B_in_Plain_English.md .

One line for Alex: Hero is the stylized fact; the minimal generative proof is congestion in the score (Pass A); p ablation tests whether assignment sorting moves the readout with score and top-K held fixed.

Limitation sentence (v1 — use as-is or lightly edit)

The empirical stylized fact uses leave-one-out teammate quality among college players; the generative proof-of-concept scores players with a penalty for leave-one-out viable-peer congestion, then selects top K, and plots binned selection rates on a matching quality axis. We do not claim bin-for-bin reproduction of every ventile in v1; we claim that talent-only scoring is insufficient and that congestion in the score can bend advancement curves in a disciplined artificial league.

What is already built (do not rebuild from scratch)

Piece	Status	Where
Empirical hero (Layer A)	Done	530 ; re_entry/HER0s_and_PASSes/HERO_*
Quadratic LPM (β₂ < 0)	Done	lpm_hero_coefficients.txt in export folder
Generative knockouts (λ=0 vs congestion)	Done	generative_knockout_*_16quantile.csv ; script sports/scripts/hero_model_reset_bundle.py
Side-by-side PNG	Done	PASS_A_inverted_u_side_by_side_empirical_vs_generative.png (re_entry/HER0s_and_PASSes/)
Narrative slide	Done	Model.pdf / Model.pptx
Plain readout	Done	generative_knockout_summary.txt , side_by_side_caption.txt

Re-run bundle if needed: python sports/scripts/hero_model_reset_bundle.py

Five-minute self-test (you’re done when these pass)

- 1. **Hero (60 s):** Naïve vs Hero; tail dip is **outcome on pool axis**, not “NBA ignores talent.”
- 2. **Binding (20 s):** environment ≠ advancement; score ≠ select (doc 03 or `Model.pdf` opener).
- 3. **Knockout (20 s):** same league + same top-K; $\lambda=0 \rightarrow S_i=A_i$; else $S_i=A_i-\lambda L_C$ with $(B-D)=-L_C$.
- 4. **Open side-by-side PNG** — left empirical, right generative; one honest limit.
- 5. **Read limitation sentence** once without hedging.

Suggested schedule (if still orienting)

Day 1 — Layer A

- Empirical hero PNG + doc 01; describe tail dip and **talent baseline**.

Day 2 — Layer C (score knockout)

- Side-by-side PNG + knockout CSVs; λ toggles `L_C` in the score, not **p** and not the winner rule.

Day 3 — Package for Alex

- `Model.pdf` + side-by-side + limitation sentence (email or brief).

Pass B: p sims (assignment ablation)

Question: Is assortative grouping (**p**) involved? **Answer:** Yes in the **full** story (step 1 — who lands where); **not** the minimal proof that congestion in the **score** matters (Pass A — λ / L_C , already run).
Run: hold **score and winner rule** fixed (λ , **L_C**, top K); vary **p** (low vs high) + sort-and-chop benchmark; same 16-bin readout on **poolq_loo**.
Script: `python sports/scripts/540_rho_ablation_bundle.py`. See `../../sports/540_READ_ME_SIM.md`.

Explicitly out of scope (park guilt here)

- Bin-for-bin replication of hero ventiles from simulation
- Separate estimation of benefit vs congestion on one axis
- **p** calibrated to match hero before minimal story is sent
- Multi-domain Λ sweeps (Army slot capacity)
- Tenure Cox / Setting 3 prose
- Re-reading agent correspondence rounds

If you get pulled into cross-references again

Rule: Close the tab. Return to `00_READ_ME_FIRST.md`.
Agents: when Charles is in re-entry, **do not** point him at `Charles_reading_list.md` items 1–14, Pertinent Thoughts, or nesting note until he finishes re_entry 01–03.

One paragraph to end the reset

You started over because the **reference surface** exceeded your **working memory**. The science for Alex v1 is **on disk** and **in your slide**. Remaining work is **Pass B p packaging** (optional with Pass A) and Alex presentation — not re-deriving the model. Everything else waits in `PARKED_FOR_LATER.md`.
When you want depth beyond the slide, see `3-Master_Plan/plans/20260721_hero_model_reset.plan.md` — not before doc 02 feels easy.